

Possible Way to Lessen AI Usage of Water?

Posted by u/WAR_FROM_GOOD_OMENS • 0 points • 15 comments

I'm not as educated on AI as I would like to be, but I'm trying to change that. Consequently, this might be a stupid question. However, I was thinking, since we know that AI centers use an insane amount of clean water to cool their facilities, maybe we can eventually get the AI people to turn off their machines sometimes and let them cool down naturally? In other words, one AI company could run for a few hours a day, then shut off to cool down, and in the meantime, other AI companies could be working before they stop, and so on. It's probably unrealistic that the AI corporates would easily oblige to an idea like this because they always want to make money, but I think there will come a point where enough people will be outraged and force them to change. Yes, I hate AI and would definitely prefer that we just shut it all down forever, but it seems that most people don't want to let go of AI completely. I would rather we compromise for the sake of water rather than not do anything.

Comments

u/dumnezero • 2 points • 2026-02-16 07:06 UTC

Factory owners hate shutting down their factories. Besides, they're offering "service" over the very fast internet, so interruptions are not part of the plan.

Stop going ~~in ass-first into a battle~~ for compromises, it's not a better strategy.

The only way they could reduce water usage is to move to colder places (part of the the tech bro regime to conquer Greenland) or make the computing more efficient -- and use that efficiency to reduce use instead of for more growth. It's not going to happen.

u/Tyrrany_of_pants • 1 points • 2026-02-16 05:19 UTC

Yeah, they can build different cooling systems. They might be more expensive to build, or use more electricity, or maybe be nosier

u/dumnezero • 1 points • 2026-02-16 07:07 UTC

<https://i.redd.it/vljs1bq93tjg1.gif>

u/WAR_FROM_GOOD_OMENS • 1 points • 2026-02-16 05:27 UTC

You're right, unfortunately. There's really no good way to fix it other than to get rid of it (which people probably won't do)

u/Tyrrany_of_pants • 2 points • 2026-02-16 06:08 UTC

Yeah, this shit is hanging around unfortunately. The large GPU datacentres might disappear, or become less common and more expensive, but the other consequences of this stuff will hang around (CSAM, slop, propaganda, ect)

u/OrFenn-D-Gamer • 1 points • 2026-02-16 04:36 UTC

best way if ai is banned

u/WAR_FROM_GOOD_OMENS • 1 points • 2026-02-16 04:37 UTC

You're preaching to the choir 😞

u/Theo__n • 2 points • 2026-02-16 04:19 UTC

Most machine learning aka AI doesn't need datacentres to run or train, it's generally huge dataset general models like llms. Some non general huge dataset models do need data centres to train, but once your model is trained you don't need to update it if it works - most commercial llms do need to train new models because they're trying to win against competition.

u/dumnezezero • 1 points • 2026-02-16 07:07 UTC

They re-train models regularly.

u/WAR_FROM_GOOD_OMENS • 1 points • 2026-02-16 04:25 UTC

So you're saying that an easier method would just be to get them to make the data centers smaller?

u/Theo__n • 2 points • 2026-02-16 04:34 UTC

No, easier method would be to not try making 'general machine learning algorithm' that in theory can do everything, but tailored ones to solving problem you need. As we did for decades, and do now but they're usually not llms architecture.

u/WAR_FROM_GOOD_OMENS • 1 points • 2026-02-16 04:42 UTC

Ah, makes sense. I'm now hoping for this to be what people do with the AI now, too. But I bet that's also going to be tricky to get the AI corporates to cooperate with, because one of the main appeals of AI is that it can "help you with anything," like how you can use Google to search up anything

u/Theo__n • 2 points • 2026-02-16 14:10 UTC

>"help you with anything,"

Sure for people that don't really need machine learning, it's efficiency pales in comparison to industry implementations like ie. climate modelling or robot energy conservation tasks. This is unfortunately what happens when you try to make an algorithm that is good for everything.

u/Dismal-Blacksmith-28 • 3 points • 2026-02-16 04:02 UTC

honestly your idea about rotating schedules makes some sense but the problem is these data centers need to run 24/7 for users around the globe. like if google or chatgpt shut down for few hours people would lose their minds

but maybe they could do rotating maintenance during low usage periods and use that time for natural cooling. the real issue is most these companies dont care about water usage until government forces them to or costs get too high

u/WAR_FROM_GOOD_OMENS • 1 points • 2026-02-16 04:08 UTC

Yeah, I am fearing that none of these companies will do anything until they are forced to, but it will probably be too late by then to make a big difference. The problems always point back to the greed of capitalism...